

Art & Design

Year 4 · Student Manual
The Wall Studio

A Cambridge Pathway student book for Lower Primary. Written for pupils of about eight to nine years old who are ready to print with purpose, paint with control, draw depth, and build simple architecture.

Four tables in one growing studio: print, paint, line and build. Rufus the fox and Bruno the bear work beside you, sometimes on a wall in the open air.

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Interior 8.5 × 11 in (Amazon KDP). British English throughout. Printed so that pencil, crayon, glue and washable paint can work on the page.

This book is meant to be used. Print in it. Paint in it. Build in it.

Safety: activities use washable paint, blunt tools, card and clay. Cutting and any outdoor mural-style work need an adult nearby. Teachers follow their school safety policy.

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Welcome to the Wall Studio

There is a long table indoors. There is also a wall outdoors that wants a picture.

This book is both places. It is called **the Wall Studio**, and it belongs to you for this Year 4.

Last year you looked carefully, built mosaics, painted from life and made simple structures. Keep that. This year you print with a reason, paint with more control, draw so space feels deep, and build a small piece of architecture you can hold.

Four kinds of making live here:

- 1 **Printing** for a clear purpose
- 2 **Painting** with brushes, colour and texture
- 3 **Drawing** with perspective and movement
- 4 **Architecture** built in three dimensions

Rufus the fox plans carefully before the stamp goes down. Bruno the bear mixes colour slowly and is happy to start a wall again if the first layer needs it.

🔄 DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Year 3 you drew from encounter, made mosaics, painted and built structure. This year the craft words get sharper: purpose, perspective, architecture. Your hands still lead. Your eyes still check.

Who you will meet



Rufus the fox

He plans a print before he presses. He likes clean edges, honest colour and buildings that stand. When a model wobbles, he redesigns the join.



Bruno the bear

He paints big first, then adds texture. He rolls colour onto a wall as if he has all afternoon. He is good at saying what a design is for.



The long table

Print blocks dry here. Paint pots rest here. Plans for buildings start as pencil boxes on this table.

You

Age about eight or nine. Ready to design with purpose, check your work, and try again without giving up.

How to use this book

The same friendly signs come back on every page. Learn them once.

✦ SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- **Open the door** - a question to talk about before you begin
- **Warm up your hands** - a quick game so your hands wake up
- **Look and learn** - something new, with a picture that shows how
- **Your turn** - time to make, print, paint, draw or build
- **Did you know?** - a true and surprising fact
- **Go a bit further** - an extra idea if you finish
- **Big challenge** - a harder task; take your time
- **How did it go?** - a short look back at your work

When you see a **dashed box**, that space is yours. Draw in it. Stick in it. There are no printed right answers for open making.



Picture 0.1 The same signs return on every page, so you always know what to do next.

Getting set up

Your studio kit

You will not need everything at once. Each unit tells you what to fetch.

- pencils (hard and soft), rubber, sharpener
- printing materials: foam block or potato, tray, roller or sponge, washable ink
- washable paints, flat and round brushes, water pot, rags
- charcoal or soft graphite for tone
- card, corrugated cardboard, tape, string, small boxes for architecture
- clay or air-dry clay (adult choice), safety scissors, glue
- apron or old shirt
- a sketchbook or spare paper that can take a print

Room norms

- 1 Look with your eyes before you touch with your hands.
- 2 Share tools. Put each tool back where it lives.
- 3 Keep water pots and ink trays steady. Wipe spills at once.
- 4 Walk with scissors closed and pointing down.
- 5 Talk about work kindly: what you notice, what the design is **for**.

✦ WARM UP YOUR HANDS

Shake your hands for five seconds. Press your palms together hard, then open them wide like stars. Do it three times. Now your hands are ready to make.



Picture 0.2 A tidy Year 4 kit: print block, paints, brushes, card and a small box ready to become a building.

UNIT 1 · PRINT TABLE

1

Printing for a purpose

Press once. Make many. Know why the print exists.

A print is a mark lifted from a prepared surface onto paper. Purpose is the job the print is made to do: a poster people read from the far end of the hall, a pattern, a gift tag, a badge.

◎ IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ print with three techniques and say what each one is good at
- ✓ choose colour on purpose, and line up a second colour
- ✓ design a print that has one clear job
- ✓ pull a matching set of final prints and label them
- ✓ run a print stall for a real audience

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Rufus lays out a foam block, a tray of washable ink and a stack of clean paper.

"A print is not a one-off drawing," he says. "You cut the block once, carefully. After that, the block does the work for you."

Bruno rolls ink until the tray hisses. "The school fair opens at 14:30 on Friday," he says. "We need forty gift tags that all look like they belong together. Try drawing forty by hand. Purpose first, then press."



Picture 1.0 The print table set out before anyone touches it: foam block, ink tray, roller and paper. Look at how much clear space is left around the tray, so a wet print never lands in a puddle.

🔄 DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Year 3 you pressed patterns with sponges and made repeating borders. You already know that a shape can come back again and again. This year you decide why it comes back, and you keep every press as clean as the first.

What you will fetch

- a foam sheet or half a potato, and a blunt pencil for pressing lines
- washable printing ink or thick paint, a shallow tray, a roller or sponge
- clean paper, plus scrap paper for tests
- found objects: cork, leaf, bottle lid, corrugated card
- an apron, a damp cloth and a line or rack for drying

✦ WARM UP YOUR HANDS

Press your thumb onto the table for two seconds. Press it again, but only half as hard. Which press would leave a fuller mark in ink? Do it three times and feel the difference between a firm, even press and a squashing one.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1

Exploring printing techniques

■ Open the door

If you could stamp one mark forty times before lunch, what mark would earn that many presses, and who would it be for?

► Here is how it works

Printing lifts ink from a prepared surface onto paper. You prepare the surface once, then repeat the press. That is the whole idea, and it is why printing is used whenever many copies must match.

Three techniques suit the Year 4 print table.

TECHNIQUE	WHAT HOLDS THE INK	BEST AT
Relief (foam or potato)	the raised parts	bold, simple shapes
Found-object	the surface of a real thing	texture and surprise
Monoprint	a smooth inked tray, drawn into	one rich, unique print

Each one has a trap. Thin lines on a relief block fill with ink and disappear. A wobbly found object slides and smudges. A monoprint cannot be repeated at all.

In a **relief** print the ink sits on the parts that stand up, so the lines you press *down* stay the colour of the paper. Beginners often expect the opposite, then wonder why their drawing came out inside out.

Monoprint starts with *mono*, which means one. You roll ink onto a tray, draw into it with a cotton bud or the wrong end of a brush, then lay paper on top. It gives one print only, because drawing into the ink destroys the picture as it prints it.



Picture 1.1 Found objects and the marks they leave: cork, leaf, bottle lid, corrugated card and half a potato. Look for the ribbed stripes from the card and the veins the leaf prints.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno makes a foam relief print of a leaf, the shape he wants on the fair tags.

- 1 He draws one simple leaf on the foam, as big as his palm, with no tiny veins.
- 2 He presses the outline and three veins in with a blunt pencil, so those lines sit lower than the surface.
- 3 He rolls a thin, even coat of ink over the block, until the roller sounds sticky rather than looking wet.
- 4 He lays paper on top and rubs the back with a flat, clean hand, from the middle outwards.
- 5 He peels the paper from one corner in one steady movement, then pegs it up.

His first press is patchy, so he re-inks and presses again without redrawing the block. By the third press the leaf is even. A block gets better as it works.



Picture 1.2 Rufus and Bruno checking three prints pulled from one foam leaf block. Look for the pressed veins staying pale, because those are the lines that sit lower than the surface.

• **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Name the technique you will try first: _____
- 2 Press three times on scrap paper, then tick what improved by the third press.
 - ☐ the ink is even, with no bald patches
 - ☐ the peel is clean, with no smudge
 - ☐ the shape still reads from across the room
- 3 Which press was best, and why do you think so?

- 4 Draw the block you will cut in the box below, big and simple.

BLOCK IDEA

✦ **DID YOU KNOW?**

More than five hundred years ago in Mainz, in Germany, Johannes Gutenberg set pages using small metal letters. Once a page was set, it could be printed again and again. One careful setting, then many copies: the same bargain you make when you cut a printing block.

→ **GO A BIT FURTHER**

Print your block onto three different surfaces: newspaper, brown parcel paper and white paper. Keep all three. Which surface holds the sharpest edge? A printer chooses paper on purpose too.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2

Using colour in printing

■ Open the door

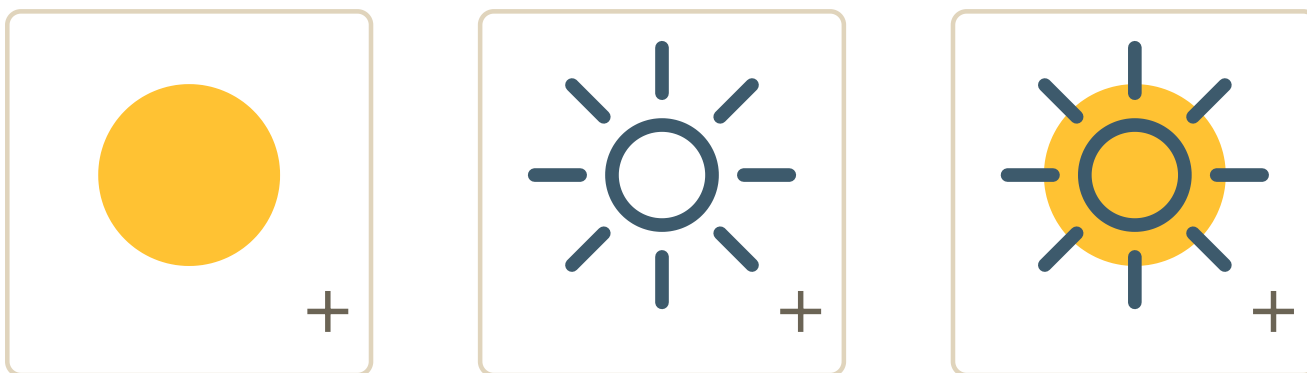
A poster must warn people about a wet floor in a busy corridor. Pale yellow on cream, or deep blue on white? Say why.

► Here is how it works

Colour in a print is chosen, not left to chance.

- **One colour** is strong, quick and clear. Most badges and logos live on one colour.
- **Two colours** need a plan: print the lighter colour first, let it dry, then print the darker one on top.
- **Contrast** is the difference between your ink and your paper, and it decides how far away your print can still be read.
- **Registration** means lining the second layer up with the first, by matching a small cross mark outside the picture.

Weak contrast makes a pretty print that nobody can read from three metres away. Strong contrast lets one shape carry the length of a hall.



Picture 1.3 The sun stamp printed in two colours: the pale layer, then the dark layer, then both together. Look at the small cross in the corner of every panel, the mark that tells you the second layer landed in the right place.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Inês prints a two-colour tile for the fair, one hundred millimetres square.

- 1 She cuts two foam blocks the same size, one for a pale square and one for the dark line pattern.
- 2 She marks a small cross on the bottom right of her paper, and the same cross on both blocks.
- 3 She prints the pale ochre square first, matching the crosses, and leaves it to dry for ten minutes.
- 4 She prints the dark blue lines on top, matching the crosses again.
- 5 Her first tile is off by about two millimetres, so she keeps it as proof and prints two more. The third is exact.

Ten minutes of drying saves a smudged tile. Ink that is still wet mixes with the next layer and turns both colours to mud.



Picture 1.4 The same stamp printed in soft yellow and then in deep blue on pale paper. Look at which of the two you can read first when you hold the page at arm's length.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Choose the job for this print, and circle one: poster · badge · gift tag · pattern paper
- 2 Write the lighter colour, the one you will print first: _____
- 3 Write the darker colour, the one that goes on top: _____
- 4 Print a test of each colour in the boxes below, then hold the page at arm's length.

LIGHTER TEST

DARKER TEST

Which colour still reads clearly from far away?



Picture 1.5 An old Lisbon wall where one tile design repeats across the whole front of the house. Look for the single tile shape first, and then for the bigger pattern your eye makes out of it.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

The patterned wall tiles you see all over Portugal are called **azulejos**, and Lisbon has a whole museum for them, the Museu Nacional do Azulejo. A tiled wall is printing's idea in clay: design one tile, repeat it, and a plain house front turns into a pattern.

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Print one shape in a colour that shouts and once in a colour that whispers. Pin both at the far end of the room. Ask a friend which one they read first, and write down what they say before you decide who was right.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3

Designing for a purpose

■ Open the door

What is your print **for**? If you cannot say the job in one sentence, the design is not ready to be cut.

► Here is how it works

A **purpose** is the job the print must do, and it decides everything else: the shape, the colour, the paper and the size.

THE JOB	WHO LOOKS AT IT	WHAT THAT DEMANDS
Tell people where the book fair is	a passer-by, walking	one bold shape, strong contrast
Decorate a notebook cover	one person, up close	a small repeating pattern
Thank a visitor	one person, in the hand	a neat tag, careful edges
Mark the quiet corner	a child from three metres away	a simple sign, no detail

Four steps take you from job to block.

- 1 Write the job in one sentence. If the sentence needs an "and", you may have two jobs and need two prints.
- 2 Choose **one** strong shape, because one good shape beats five weak ones.
- 3 Leave space around the shape so it can breathe. Crowded prints look shouty and read as a blur.
- 4 Test small before you commit to good paper.



Picture 1.6 Rufus's badge plan for the quiet reading corner: the open-book shape drawn big, two colour swatches beside it, and two test cards already pulled. Look at how much paper he leaves empty around the shape.

✦ **DID YOU KNOW?**

Portugal produces more cork than any other country, and cork is a printer's friend. Slice a wine cork across, cut a notch into the flat face, and you have a small stamp that fits a child's hand and prints hundreds of times.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus designs a badge for the quiet reading corner in the library at Estoril.

- 1 Job.** Help a child spot the quiet corner from the library door.
- 2 Shape.** One open book. He tries a book with a lamp and a chair, then throws that away, because three things at badge size become a smudge.
- 3 Colour.** Deep green on cream. Calm suits a quiet corner, and green still reads from the door.
- 4 Test.** Two small presses on scrap, one in each colour he is weighing up. He picks the cleaner, then cuts the final block.

He checks the badge by standing where a reader stands, not where the maker stands.

• **YOUR TURN**

Write the job of your print in one sentence, without using the word "and".

Who will look at it, and from how far away?

Sketch the one strong shape you will cut, filling the box below.

THE ONE SHAPE

→ **GO A BIT FURTHER**

Design the same job twice: once for a poster on a wall and once for a tag in a hand. Keep the shape, change the size and the amount of empty space. Which one had to lose detail, and why?

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.4

Producing a final print

Open the door

When is a print finished: when you are bored of pressing, or when the job is done well? Who decides?

► Here is how it works

A **final print** is the best press of a planned design, on chosen paper, dried flat and labelled. A set of matching final prints is called an **edition**, and printers number them so nobody has to guess which is which.

Run the checklist before the final press.

- ☐ the job is written in one sentence
- ☐ the block is clean, with no dried ink in the pressed lines
- ☐ the ink is thin and even, sticky rather than wet
- ☐ the paper is cut and dry, with the registration cross marked
- ☐ your hands are clean for the peel
- ☐ there is space on the line or rack for the print to dry flat

Then press, peel, and hang it up. Write your name, the date and the job on the back of every print, in pencil, once it is dry.



Picture 1.7 Prints from one block pegged up to dry, with a blank label slip clipped beside each one. Look at how alike they are, because that likeness is what makes them an edition instead of a pile of separate tries.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno pulls an edition of four tags for the fair.

- 1 He cuts four cards, each 60 by 90 millimetres, and marks a cross on the back of each one.
- 2 He re-inks between every press, always the same thin coat.
- 3 Tag two comes out pale, so he sets it aside instead of pressing harder, because pressing harder squashes the foam and spreads the shape.
- 4 He prints two more, so he ends with four good tags out of six pulls.
- 5 He labels each one on the back in pencil: *leaf block, fair tag, 12 August 2026*.

Two rejects out of six is normal, and honest. An edition is the prints that matched, not every print you made.

• **YOUR TURN**

Press your final print, dry it flat, then finish these lines.

The job of this print:

How many pulls did you make, and how many matched?

What would you change if you cut the block again?

STICK YOUR FINAL PRINT HERE, OR A PHOTO OF IT

▲ **BIG CHALLENGE**

Print an edition of **four** matching invitations for one real event in your school. Number them 1 of 4, 2 of 4, 3 of 4 and 4 of 4 in pencil on the back. Anyone should be able to shuffle them and still see one design, not four attempts.

The print stall

◆ FINAL PROJECT: RUN THE PRINT STALL

The school fair opens at 14:30 on Friday in the hall. Your table sells nothing and gives everything away: printed gift tags, pattern paper, and one poster that tells people where your table is.

What your stall needs

ITEM	HOW MANY	ITS JOB
Poster	1	bring a visitor across the hall
Gift tags	8 matching	something to take away
Pattern paper	2 sheets	show the block repeating
Label card	1	name the block and the colours you chose

Plan it here

My block will be: _____ My colours: _____

The poster's job, in one sentence:

Sketch your poster small, with the shape big enough to see from far away.

POSTER PLAN

Run it, then answer

How many visitors stopped at your table? _____

What did the poster do well?



Picture 1.8 A print stall at a school fair: one poster on the board, a stack of matching tags, pattern paper and two visitors waiting. Look at how the poster's single shape is readable from further away than anything on the table.

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I printed with at least two techniques and can name what each is good at.
- ☐ I chose my colours on purpose, and I can say why.
- ☐ My print has one clear job, in one sentence.
- ☐ I pulled a matching edition and labelled it.

The hardest part was:

Next time I would start by:

🕒 WHAT CAN YOU DO NOW?

- ✓ explain the difference between a relief print and a monoprint
- ✓ line up a second colour using a registration cross
- ✓ say who a print is for, and how far away they stand
- ✓ tell an edition apart from a pile of tries

→ WHAT GOES TO THE STUDIO SHOW

The studio show at the end of this book asks for one piece from every table. Keep these three safe in your folder, because the print table's evidence comes from this unit.

- ✓ your final print, with its one-sentence job written on the back
- ✓ one test sheet that shows three presses of the same block
- ✓ the poster from your print stall, or a photograph of the stall

◇ WORDS YOU NOW OWN

print · relief print · monoprint · found-object print · purpose · contrast · registration · edition · azulejo

UNIT 2 · PAINT TABLE

2

Approaches to painting

Brush, colour, texture, and the real thing in front of you.

Painting is more than filling a shape in. How you hold the brush, how you mix the colour and how you build the surface all change what the picture says.

🕒 IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

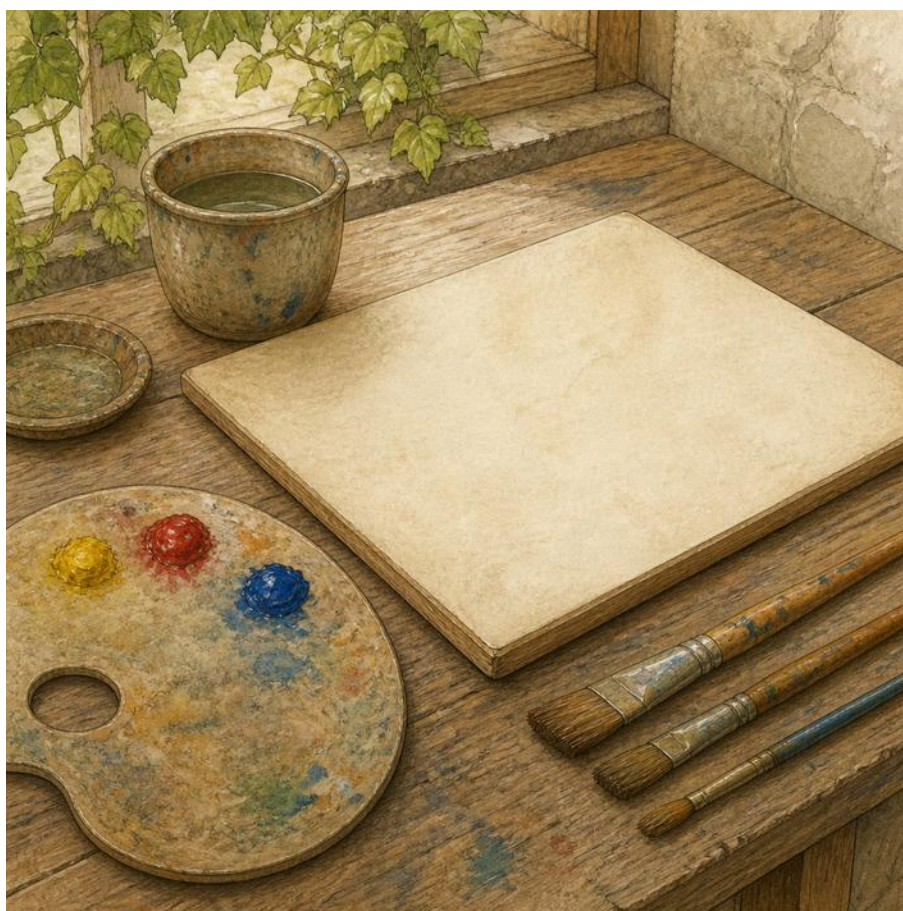
- ✓ use five brush techniques and say what each one is good for
- ✓ mix a colour on purpose, for a mood or to match something real
- ✓ build texture with paint instead of drawing every detail
- ✓ paint from observation, with the real thing in front of you
- ✓ finish a painted panel for the studio wall

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Bruno sets out two brushes, a water pot and three tubes: red, yellow and blue.

"Same wall, different brushes," he says, looking at the mural sketch. "A wide brush covers. A thin tip draws a branch. A dry brush scratches bark."

Rufus lines up the tubes. "And three colours are enough. If I want the green of that leaf, I mix it. There is no tube in the world with exactly that green in it."



Picture 2.0 The paint table before work starts: red, yellow and blue on the palette, three brushes, a water pot and a blank board. Look at the empty board, because every colour is tried there before it goes anywhere near the painting.

 DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Unit 1 you chose a colour on purpose, so a print would carry across a room. Painting asks the same question and then a harder one: not only which colour, but how wet, how thick, and with which brush.

What you will fetch

- watercolour or ready-mix paint in red, yellow and blue, plus white
- a flat brush and a round brush, and one old brush for dry work
- two water pots, one for washing out and one kept clean
- thick paper that will not cockle, plus scrap paper for tests
- a rag or kitchen paper, a palette or an old white plate, an apron
- one real object to paint from: fruit, a jug, a plant, a shell

 WARM UP YOUR HANDS

Load a brush with clean water and paint a wet stripe. Now touch one dot of colour into the wet stripe and watch it travel by itself. That travelling is what a wash does, and you steer it by how wet the paper is.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.1

Experimenting with brush techniques **Open the door**

Which brush would you use for a wide evening sky, and which for a thin fence wire? What happens if you swap them?

 Here is how it works

The brush is not one tool. It is five, and the difference is in how much water you carry and how you land the stroke.

TECHNIQUE	HOW IT LOOKS	TRY IT FOR
Wash	thin, even, wet	sky, water, a large background
Dry brush	scratchy, broken	bark, grass, a rough wall
Dab	soft, repeated spots	leaves, blossom, clouds
Line with the tip	thin and controlled	twigs, wires, window frames
Scumble	broken colour over dry paint	weather, age, worn stone

Two habits make all five work. Keep one water pot clean, because grey water turns every colour to mud. And let a layer dry before you put another on top, unless you actually want the colours to run together.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Watercolour dries lighter than it looks when it is wet, and thick paint dries darker. Painters learn their own materials by keeping a test strip beside the work and comparing it after it dries, instead of trusting the wet colour.



Picture 2.1 Five brush marks on one test strip: wash, dry brush, dab, thin line and scumble. Look at how much white paper still shows through the dry brush mark.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno paints the top half of the mural sketch: a soft sky above a rough wall.

- 1 He wets the sky area with clean water first, so the colour can spread evenly.
- 2 He drops in blue at the top and lets it travel down into the damp paper.
- 3 He waits. The sky dries about a shade lighter than it looked when wet.
- 4 He loads an old brush, wipes most of the paint off on the rag, then drags it sideways across the wall area.
- 5 The dry brush skips over the paper and leaves broken marks, which read as rough stone.

He does not paint the wall while the sky is wet. Wet meeting wet would blur the line where the wall begins.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Make a test strip with all five techniques, one in each box below.
- 2 Label each box as you go, so you can name what you did.
- 3 Which technique surprised you most?

WASH

DRY BRUSH

DAB

THIN LINE

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Paint the same simple tree twice: once with a thin brush for every branch, once by dabbing the whole crown as one soft shape. Which one looks more like a tree from across the room?

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.2

Mixing and using colour

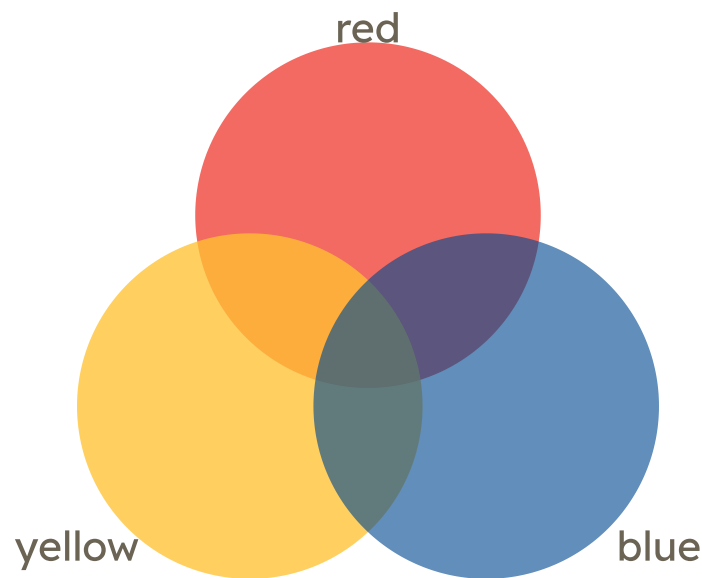
■ Open the door

Can you mix a grey without opening a tube labelled grey? What would you put in it?

► Here is how it works

Three colours and white will take you almost anywhere.

- **Primary** colours are red, yellow and blue. You cannot mix them from anything else.
- **Secondary** colours come from two primaries: orange, green and purple.
- A **tint** is a colour with white added, or with more water in watercolour.
- A **shade** is a colour with a little of its opposite added, which is how you get a rich grey instead of a dead one.
- **Warm** colours (red, orange, yellow) feel busy and close. **Cool** colours (blue, green, violet) feel calm and far away.



Picture 2.2 Three primary colours laid over each other. Look at the three places where two circles cross, because that is where orange, green and purple appear without any tube of orange, green or purple.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Inês mixes the exact green of a bay leaf from the studio window.

- 1 She starts with yellow, because a leaf green is mostly yellow, not mostly blue.
- 2 She adds blue a little at a time, on the tip of the brush, stirring between each touch.
- 3 She paints a test dab on scrap paper and holds it right beside the real leaf.
- 4 Her mix is too bright, so she adds the smallest touch of red, which calms it down.
- 5 She writes the recipe next to the dab: *yellow, a little blue, a speck of red.*

Holding the test beside the real leaf is the whole trick. A colour that looks right on the palette can look wrong on the paper.



Picture 2.3 Bruno painting birds onto the mural, with the palette in front: a calm blue-green pool and an excited orange-red pool. Look at how far apart the two pools sit, so a brush moving between them does not drag one colour into the other.

• **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Mix a **calm** colour and paint it in the first box below.
- 2 Mix an **excited** colour and paint it in the second box.
- 3 Write what you added to change the mood:
- 4 Mix a grey from your three primaries, with no white. Where did you use it?

CALM MIX

EXCITED MIX

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Ultramarine, the deep blue of many old paintings, was once ground from lapis lazuli, a stone carried across the sea from far away. It cost more than gold, so painters saved it for the most important part of a picture. Today the same blue comes from a tube and costs very little.

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Paint one small square using only mixes of two primaries. No third tube, no white. See how many different colours you can pull out of just two.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.3

Exploring textures in painting

■ Open the door

How can paint tell you a wall is rough, without drawing a single brick?

► Here is how it works

Texture is how a surface seems to feel. In paint you suggest it rather than draw it, and there are four reliable ways.

- 1 Dry brush over a dry layer, so the paper breaks the stroke up.
- 2 Dab with a sponge or a crumpled rag, which gives a random, natural speckle.
- 3 Put thick paint next to a thin wash, so one area sits up and the other sinks back.
- 4 Leave tiny gaps of white paper, which read as sparkle on stone, water or fur.

Painters call paint laid on thickly enough to stand up off the surface **impasto**. You can see the ridges of the brush in it, and it catches real light.



Picture 2.4 Rufus and Bruno painting leaves straight onto a rough plaster wall outdoors. Look at how the wall's own grain breaks every stroke into pieces, which is exactly what dry brushing imitates on paper.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno paints a brick wall without painting bricks.

- 1 He lays a light wash of warm grey over the whole wall area and lets it dry.
- 2 He dry-brushes a slightly darker tone across it in short sideways strokes.
- 3 He adds a few thin darker lines where mortar would run, but only a few.
- 4 He stops. Three suggestions read as a wall; forty outlined bricks read as a chart.

The hard part of texture is stopping. Every extra mark makes the surface busier and the wall less believable.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Paint a **smooth** surface in the left half of the box below.
- 2 Paint a **rough** surface in the right half, using a different technique.
- 3 Name the technique you used for rough: _____
- 4 Which half took fewer marks to look right?

SMOOTH, THEN ROUGH

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Find three real surfaces in your classroom: a window, a jumper, a wooden table. Paint a small patch of each so a friend can guess which is which without being told.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.4

Working from observation

Open the door

What changes if you paint a plant from memory instead of from the plant on the table in front of you?

► **Here is how it works**

Observation means looking at the real thing while you paint, not before you paint.

The loop is short and you repeat it: look, paint a little, look again, correct.

Order matters as much as looking.

- 1 Big shapes first, blocked in loosely, with no detail at all.
- 2 Edges second, deciding which are sharp and which are soft.
- 3 Colour matched by testing beside the object, as you did in 2.2.
- 4 Tiny highlights last, and only a few of them.

The commonest mistake is starting with the detail you like best, usually a highlight or an outline, and then discovering the big shape underneath it is the wrong size.



Picture 2.5 A still life set up on the table with a half-finished painting propped beside it. Look at how the painting keeps the big shapes loose while the real objects sit in plain view.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus paints a lemon from the fruit bowl, in twenty minutes.

- 1 He turns the lemon until the shape is interesting, then leaves it alone.
- 2 He blocks in the whole lemon as one flat yellow oval, wrong in places, and does not fuss.
- 3 He mixes a shadow colour from yellow with a speck of blue, and puts it where the lemon curves away from the window.
- 4 He compares, and finds his oval too round, so he corrects the left edge.
- 5 He leaves one small patch of white paper as the shine, without painting white over the top.

His painting looks like that lemon on that day, which is what observation gets you and memory does not.

✧ DID YOU KNOW?

Josefa de Óbidos painted in Portugal more than three hundred years ago, and among her best known works are still lifes: bowls of fruit, flowers and sweets, painted from close looking. Painting the ordinary things on a table is an old and serious job, not a warm-up.

• **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Set one real object on the table where you can see it clearly.
- 2 Paint it in the box below, big shapes first, working the loop.
- 3 Write one colour you matched from life: _____
- 4 Write one thing you corrected after looking again:

OBSERVATION PAINTING

▲ **BIG CHALLENGE**

Paint the same object twice: once in twenty minutes and once in five. Keep both. The quick one usually catches the big shape better, and that is worth knowing about your own hands.

The studio wall panel

◆ FINAL PROJECT: PAINT A PANEL FOR THE STUDIO WALL

One panel, painted by you, to hang with the others. It has to use every technique from this unit, which is why the subject is a view rather than a single object.

What the panel needs

PART OF THE PANEL	TECHNIQUE IT MUST USE	WHY
Sky or background	wash	one even area holds the picture together
A rough surface	dry brush or scumble	shows texture without drawing detail
Foliage or pattern	dab	soft repeated shapes, quickly made
Thin details	line with the brush tip	wires, twigs, frames, last of all

Plan it here

My view will be: My three colours:

Which part gets the wash, and why that part?

Sketch the big shapes only, in the box below. No detail yet.

BIG SHAPES PLAN

When it is dry

One thing that worked:

One thing I would paint differently:



Picture 2.6 A finished panel standing against the studio wall while Rufus and Bruno look it over. Look for the three techniques of this unit in one picture: the washed sky, the dry-brushed stone, the dabbed foliage.

→ **WHAT GOES TO THE STUDIO SHOW**

The paint table's evidence for the studio show comes from this unit. Keep these three safe in your folder.

- ✓ your studio wall panel, dry and flat
- ✓ the brush test strip with all five techniques labelled
- ✓ your observation painting, with the colour you matched written beside it

🕒 HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I can name five brush techniques and what each is for.
- ☐ I mixed a colour on purpose, and I can say what I put in it.
- ☐ I showed texture with paint, not with outlines.
- ☐ I painted something real while looking at it.

The technique I trust most now:

The one I want more practice with:

🕒 WHAT CAN YOU DO NOW?

- ✓ choose a brush technique to fit the surface you are painting
- ✓ mix a secondary colour, a tint and a shade from three primaries
- ✓ keep one water pot clean, and say why it matters
- ✓ paint from observation using the look, paint, look again loop

◇ WORDS YOU NOW OWN

wash · dry brush · dab · scumble · impasto · primary · secondary · tint · shade · observation

UNIT 3 · LINE TABLE

3

Drawing with perspective

Space that goes back. Figures that move.

*Perspective is a set of drawing tricks that make flat paper feel deep.
Dynamism means the figure or scene looks as if it could move.*

🕒 IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ use simple one- and two-point perspective
- ✓ draw figures that feel active, not stiff
- ✓ use line, tone and shading to show depth
- ✓ combine space and movement in one composition

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Rufus draws a long corridor with lines that meet at a point on the horizon.

"If every line of the floor runs to the same point," he says, "your eye believes the corridor goes back."

Bruno sketches a fox mid-jump. "Stiff legs look like a statue," he says. "Bent legs look like a jump."



Picture 3.0 Line table: a vanishing-point diagram and a figure gesture sketch side by side.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.1

Understanding one- and two-point perspective

■ Open the door

Why do railway tracks look as if they meet far away, even though they stay the same distance apart?

► Here is how it works

- **Horizon line:** where the sky seems to meet the ground (or your eye level).
- **Vanishing point:** the place on the horizon where parallel lines appear to meet.
- **One-point perspective:** one vanishing point (looking straight down a road or room).
- **Two-point perspective:** two vanishing points (looking at the corner of a box or building).

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus draws a road in one-point perspective.

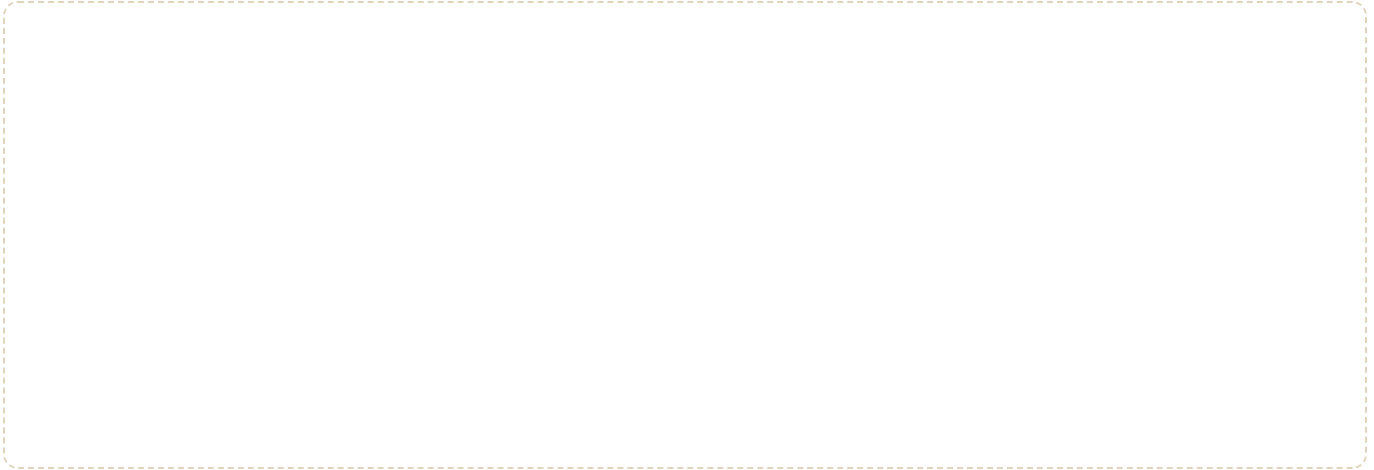
- 1 Horizon line across the page.
- 2 One vanishing point in the middle.
- 3 Road edges run from the bottom corners toward that point.
- 4 Trees get smaller as they get closer to the vanishing point.



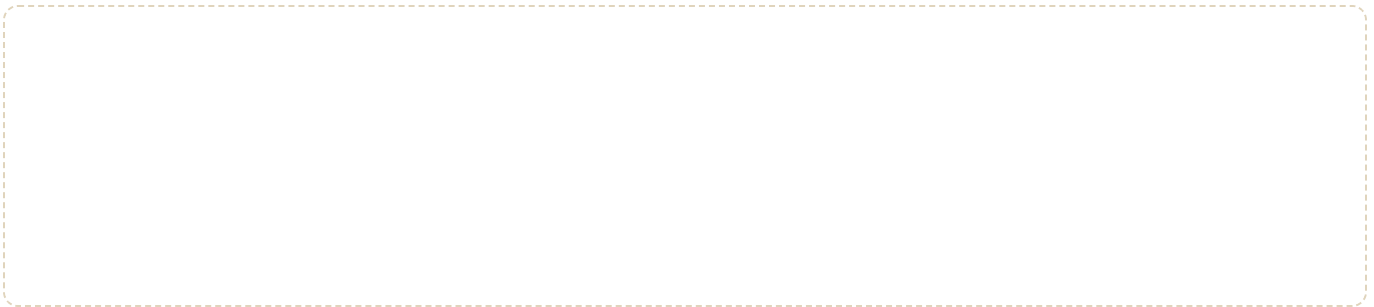
Picture 3.1 A simple road in one-point perspective with trees getting smaller into the distance.

• **YOUR TURN**

Draw a corridor or road in **one-point** perspective.



Optional: draw a box using **two** vanishing points on the horizon.



UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.2

Drawing dynamic figures

■ Open the door

Can you tell a walking person from a standing person with only a few lines?

► Here is how it works

A **dynamic figure** looks ready to move.

Tricks for age eight and nine:

- 1 Start with a line of action (a curve through the body).
- 2 Keep heads simple; spend time on big limb directions.

- 3 Overlap arms and legs so the body is not a flat sticker.
- 4 Capture a moment: mid-step, mid-reach, mid-turn.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Gesture drawings are often timed (30 to 60 seconds). The goal is energy, not pretty faces. Artists fill pages of gesture warm-ups before a careful drawing.



Picture 3.2 Three quick gesture figures: walking, reaching, turning, drawn with a clear line of action.

• YOUR TURN

Do four quick gesture sketches (about 45 seconds each). Pick one pose to refine.

1

2

3

4

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.3

Using line, tone and shading for depth

■ Open the door

Which looks closer: a dark, sharp tree, or a pale, soft tree?

► Here is how it works

Depth tools that work with perspective:

TOOL	NEAR	FAR
Line	thicker, sharper	thinner, lighter
Tone	darker, more contrast	paler, softer
Detail	more edges visible	fewer details
Overlap	object in front covers part of the one behind	-

• YOUR TURN

Draw two hills: a near hill with stronger tone, a far hill with softer tone.



Picture 3.3 Near dark hill with a clear edge and far pale hill with a soft edge under one sky.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.4

Combining perspective and movement in composition

■ Open the door

Can a figure run toward the vanishing point so both space and movement show?

► Here is how it works

A strong **composition** places the parts on purpose.

Ideas:

- 1 A path in one-point perspective with a figure walking into depth.
- 2 A building corner in two-point perspective with a figure turning the corner.
- 3 Leave empty space (breathing room) so the movement can be read.

▲ BIG CHALLENGE

Make one A4 drawing that uses **perspective** and at least one **dynamic figure**. Title it. Be ready to explain where the vanishing point is.

• YOUR TURN

Plan your composition in thumbnail form, then draw the final.

THUMBNAIL PLAN

FINAL COMPOSITION

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I can place a vanishing point on a horizon.
- ☐ I drew a figure that looks active.
- ☐ I used tone or line weight for depth.
- ☐ My final piece uses both space and movement.

My vanishing point is: _____

UNIT 4 • BUILD TABLE

4

Architecture in 3D

Forms that stand. Spaces people could use.

Architecture is the design of buildings and spaces. In this unit you study forms, build simple models, test materials, and finish a small 3D project.

🕒 IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ notice architectural forms in real buildings and pictures
- ✓ construct simple 3D models that stand
- ✓ try materials and textures for surfaces
- ✓ complete one architectural project with a clear purpose

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Bruno stacks three clean boxes. "If this is a tower," he says, "it needs a base wider than the top, or it will tip when the window opens."

Rufus sketches an arch. "Arches carry weight to the sides," he says. "A square window is different from a door you can walk through. Architecture is for people."



Picture 4.0 Build table: card, boxes, tape, clay and a simple tower model in progress.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.1

Studying architectural forms

■ Open the door

What is the difference between a wall that only looks pretty and a wall that also holds a roof?

► Here is how it works

Common **architectural forms**:

FORM	WHAT IT DOES	EASY MODEL IDEA
Column	holds weight up	tube or rolled card
Arch	spans an opening	card curve on two posts
Dome	covers a space	half sphere of clay or paper
Beam	bridges two supports	flat card strip
Wall	divides space	flat card plane

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Many Portuguese town centres mix stone walls, tiled roofs and arched doorways. Looking at a real street is a free architecture lesson if you name the forms you see.



Picture 4.1 Simple labelled forms: column, arch, dome, beam and wall as clear shapes.

• YOUR TURN

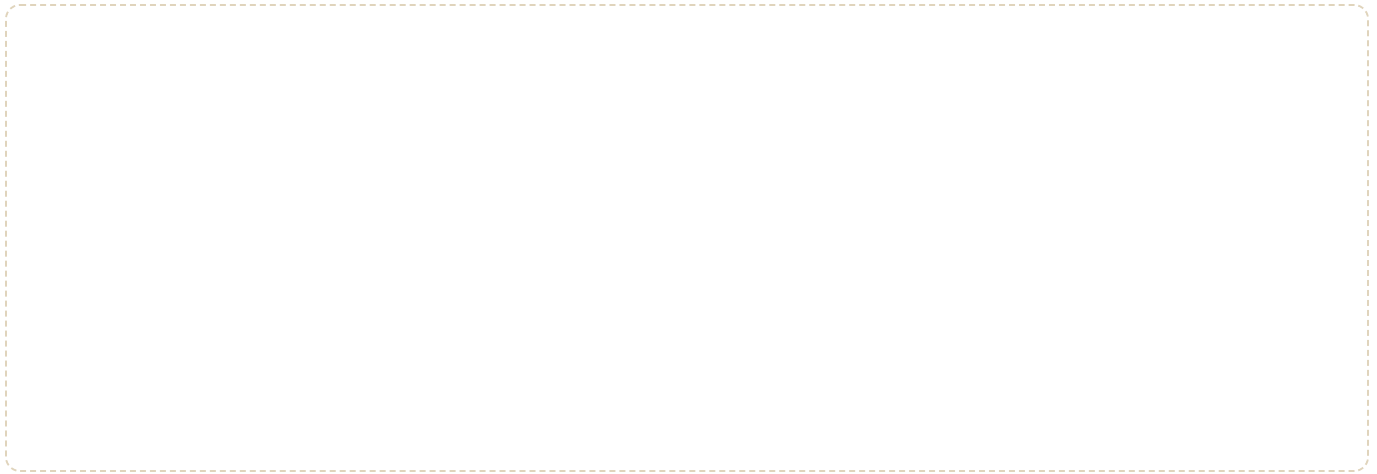
Walk (or look from a window) and list three architectural forms you can see.

1

2

3

Sketch one building corner with at least two named forms:



UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.2

Constructing simple 3D models

■ Open the door

When does a model stop being a drawing and start being a building?

► Here is how it works

A **3D model** has height, width and depth. It must **stand**.

Build rules:

- 1 Design for a purpose (bridge for toy cars, shelter for a figure, tower for a light).
- 2 Make a base that is stable.
- 3 Join carefully (slot, tape, glue, clay join).

4 Test by gentle tap: does it wobble?

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus builds a two-level card house.

- 1 Purpose: shelter for a small clay figure.
- 2 Base: wide card rectangle.
- 3 Walls: four pieces with door cut in one.
- 4 Roof: folded card, not too heavy.
- 5 Test: he taps the table; the house stays up. He adds a tape brace at one corner.



Picture 4.2 A simple two-level card house with a wide base and a door opening.

• YOUR TURN

Build a quick model with a clear purpose. Draw the plan first.

Purpose:

PLAN

After building, tick:

- ☐ it stands without holding
 - ☐ it matches the purpose
 - ☐ I can name one join I used
-

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.3

Experimenting with materials and textures

■ Open the door

Would a roof feel different if it were smooth paper or corrugated card?

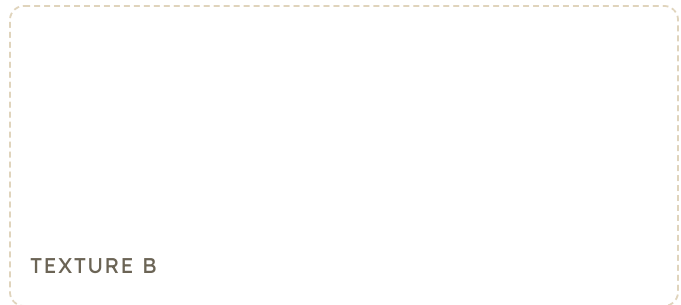
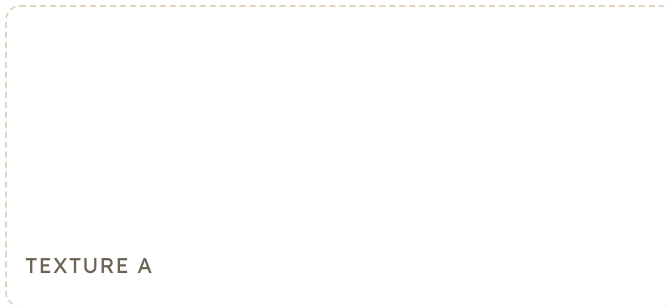
► Here is how it works

Materials change strength and surface:

MATERIAL	STRENGTH IDEA	TEXTURE IDEA
smooth card	clean walls	flat paint or pencil brick
corrugated card	light but stiff	roof ridges
clay	moulded forms	pressed patterns
fabric scrap	soft curtain	weave showing
sticks / straws	beams	line pattern

• YOUR TURN

Cover two walls of a small model with **different** textures.



Which texture is stronger for a roof? Why?



Picture 4.3 Two wall samples: corrugated roof texture beside smooth painted plaster texture.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.4

Completing a 3D architectural project

■ Open the door

What would a visitor need to know about your building in one sentence?

► Here is how it works

Your **final project** should:

- 1 have a written purpose
- 2 stand on its own
- 3 show at least two architectural forms
- 4 use materials chosen on purpose
- 5 include a short label (title, name, purpose)

▲ BIG CHALLENGE

Design and build a mini public building (library corner, bus shelter, stage, or lookout). Present it at the studio show with a label.

• **YOUR TURN**

TITLE

Purpose:

Forms used:

Materials:

PHOTO OR DRAWING OF FINISHED MODEL

Studio show

Choose one print, one painting, one drawing and your architecture model (or the strongest three pieces if time is short).

For each piece, be ready to say:

- 1 What was the purpose?
- 2 What material or technique did you choose?
- 3 What would you improve next time?

STUDIO SHOW PLAN

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I can name architectural forms.
- ☐ I built a model that stands.
- ☐ I tried more than one material or texture.
- ☐ I finished a project with a clear purpose.

My proudest structure is:

Studio words

See the full list in the glossary section printed with this book (04-GLOSSARY-01.md in the manuscript). Quick refresh:

perspective · vanishing point · purpose · relief print · texture · architecture · composition · observation · dynamism · wash

Answers

Open making has no single right answer, so the dashed boxes are never marked here. What follows is the answer where a question has one, and what a strong answer shows where it does not.

Unit 1 Printing for a purpose

1.1 Exploring printing techniques

- In a relief print the ink sits on the raised parts, so any line you press down stays the colour of the paper.
- A monoprint cannot be repeated, because drawing into the ink destroys the picture in the act of printing it. *Mono* means one.
- A found-object print takes the surface of a real thing, so corrugated card gives ribbed stripes and a leaf gives its veins.
- Your turn, question 3: a strong answer points at evidence rather than a feeling, for example "the third press, because the edge is sharp and there are no bald patches".

1.2 Using colour in printing

- Open the door: deep blue on white. The contrast is strong, so the warning still reads from the far end of a busy corridor. Pale yellow on cream nearly disappears at that distance.
- Your turn: the darker of the two colours almost always reads first from across the room, because it differs more from the paper.
- The second colour is lined up by matching the small registration cross, and the lighter colour is printed first so the darker one can sit on top of it.

1.3 Designing for a purpose

- If the one-sentence job needs the word "and", the print is being asked to do two jobs and should probably become two prints.
- A passer-by who is walking needs one bold shape with plenty of space around it. A tag held in the hand can carry finer detail, because the viewer is close.
- A strong plan can say who looks at the print, and from how far away, before any block is cut.

1.4 Producing a final print

- An edition is the set of prints that matched, not every print that was pulled. Two rejects out of six pulls is ordinary and honest.

- A pale print is not fixed by pressing harder, because pressing harder squashes the block and spreads the shape. Re-ink thinly and press evenly instead.
- The back of every final print carries the name, the date and the job, in pencil, written after the print is dry.

Sources and references

The scheme of work in PDF/Input is scope only. Full source notes for teachers are kept in 05-SOURCES-01.md. This student book does not copy third-party prose or art.

For teachers

How this book is built

- Four units map 1:1 to the 2025-2026 school scheme of work.
- Feature grammar matches the Prime Books lower-primary Art line (Y1-Y3).
- Write-on boxes are intentional empty space; do not fill them before printing.
- Open making tasks have no printed answer key.

Cambridge Pathway note

Cambridge does not publish a standalone Primary Art examination syllabus comparable to core subjects. This book is written for Prime School's Cambridge Pathway context: age-appropriate craft skill, purpose, evaluation and materials language. It is an independent Prime School publication.

Assessments (fold into Studio show)

CHECKPOINT	EVIDENCE
Unit 1	final print with written purpose
Unit 2	observation painting + brush test strip
Unit 3	perspective drawing with dynamic figure
Unit 4	standing 3D model with label

School activities

- Print a class pattern for a shared display board.
- Paint a collaborative mural panel outdoors only with full safety plan.
- Architecture walk: photograph three forms, sketch one on return.
- Studio show for families: four tables (print, paint, line, build).

Materials planning

Order washable printing ink, foam sheets, card, corrugated card and air-dry clay in advance of Units 1 and 4. Unit 3 needs only dry media if paint is short.

